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ROLLOUT

TROUBLESHOOTING GUIDE^{IP}

GET YOUR ENTIRE TEAM RUNNING
ON EOS[®] TO ACHIEVE YOUR VISION

ROLLOUTBOOK.COM

The significant problems we face cannot be solved at the same level of thinking we were at when we created them. –Albert Einstein



No Rollout goes perfectly. Even with careful preparation, clear communication, and strong leadership commitment, you'll hit bumps that test your resolve and require some creative problem-solving. This troubleshooting guide covers the most common Rollout challenges we've seen across hundreds of implementations, along with ideas for getting things back on track.

Running into these issues doesn't mean your Rollout is broken; it means you're human. Every successful EOS® organization has faced similar obstacles and found ways to overcome them.

COVERED ISSUES

ISSUE #1: PEOPLE KEEP SAYING THEY DON'T HAVE TIME FOR EOS

ISSUE #2: LEVEL 10 MEETINGS FEEL FORCED, BORING, OR UNPRODUCTIVE

ISSUE #3: ROCKS CONSISTENTLY DON'T GET COMPLETED

ISSUE #4: MID-MANAGERS SEEM RESISTANT OR DISENGAGED

ISSUE #5: DIFFERENT DEPARTMENTS ARE IMPLEMENTING EOS INCONSISTENTLY

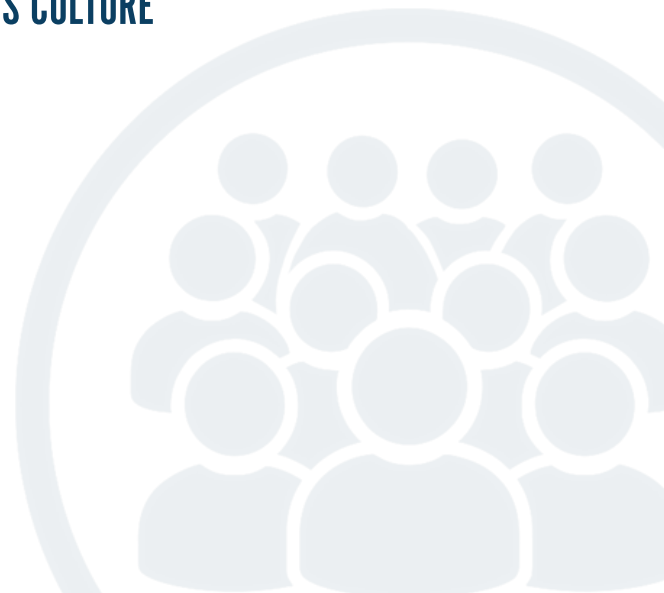
ISSUE #6: PEOPLE DON'T UNDERSTAND OR REMEMBER THE VISION

ISSUE #7: SCORECARDS AREN'T DRIVING THE RIGHT CONVERSATIONS OR ACTIONS

ISSUE #8: INITIAL ENTHUSIASM HAS FADED AND OLD HABITS ARE RETURNING

ISSUE #9: NEW HIRES AREN'T INTEGRATING WELL INTO THE EOS CULTURE

ISSUE #10: NEW LEADERS ARE UNDERMINING EOS DISCIPLINE



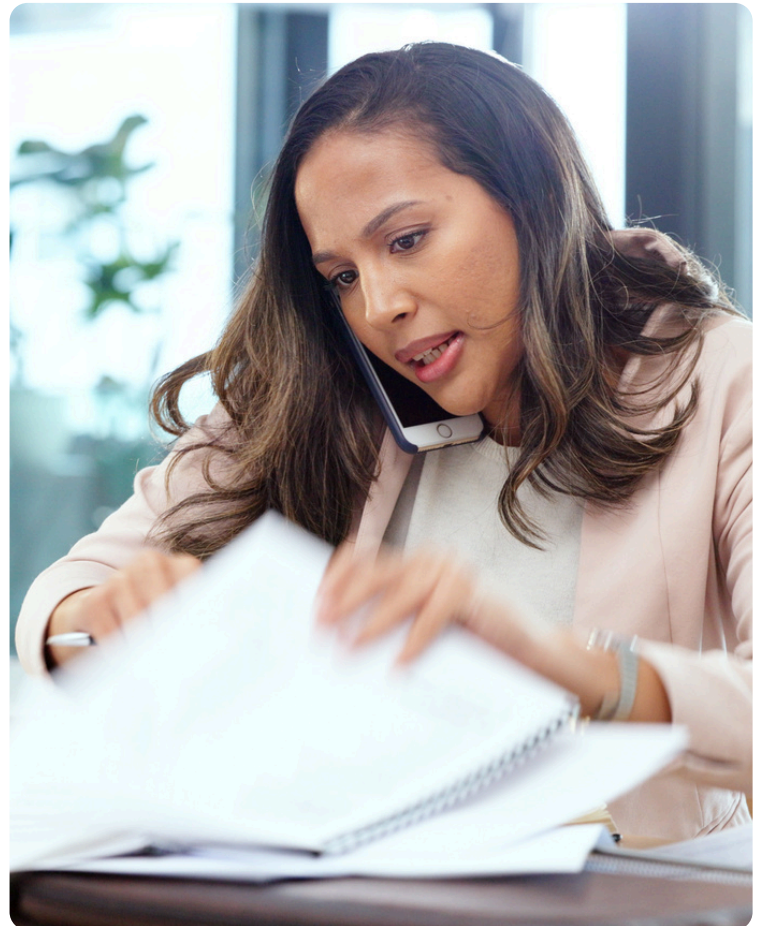
PEOPLE KEEP SAYING THEY DON'T HAVE TIME FOR EOS

COMMON SYMPTOMS

- Skipping or showing up late to Level 10 Meetings®
- Not preparing for meetings or treating EOS activities as "extra work"
- Complaining about "more meetings" when departments start Level 10 Meetings
- Rock completion rates consistently below 80 percent
- People asking to "just get an update" instead of attending meetings

POSSIBLE ROOT CAUSES

- **Seeing EOS as a Program, Not an Operating System:** People see EOS as additional work rather than a better way of working
- **Poor Prioritization:** Leadership hasn't made it clear that EOS disciplines aren't optional
- **Genuine Overload:** Teams really are swamped and need help with capacity
- **Old Habits Die Hard:** People default to reactive, crisis-driven work instead of planning ahead



THINGS TO TRY

- Have honest conversations about EOS being non-negotiable (not mean, just clear)
- Take a hard look at what people are actually spending time on and eliminate the stuff that doesn't matter
- Share real examples of time saved through better alignment—make the ROI visible
- Do a "Stop Doing" exercise to cut activities that don't align with your Core Focus
- Help managers learn to protect their team's time and say no to distractions
- Face the music on Right People Right Seats issues with chronic resisters

LEVEL 10 MEETINGS FEEL FORCED, BORING, OR UNPRODUCTIVE



COMMON SYMPTOMS

- Meeting ratings consistently below 8/10
- People checking phones or zoning out during meetings
- Off-track Scorecard measurables that nobody talks about
- IDS® sessions that spin in circles without solving anything
- To-dos that never get done
- Same issues showing up week after week
- People showing up unprepared or leaving early

POSSIBLE ROOT CAUSES

- **Weak Facilitation:** Meeting leaders don't know how to keep things moving and focused
- **Wrong Issues:** People bring updates or complaints instead of real problems to solve
- **Meaningless Numbers:** Scorecard metrics that don't actually drive decisions
- **Leader/Manager Not Bought In:** If leaders aren't taking it seriously, nobody else will

THINGS TO TRY

- Get some facilitation training for meeting leaders (it's a skill, not magic)
- Fix your Scorecard so the numbers actually matter and spark conversation
- Practice IDS until it feels natural—it's awkward at first, but gets better
- Set ground rules: phones away, laptops closed, everyone engaged
- Show examples of "good issues" vs. "bad issues" so people bring the right stuff
- Try different facilitators to find who's naturally good at it

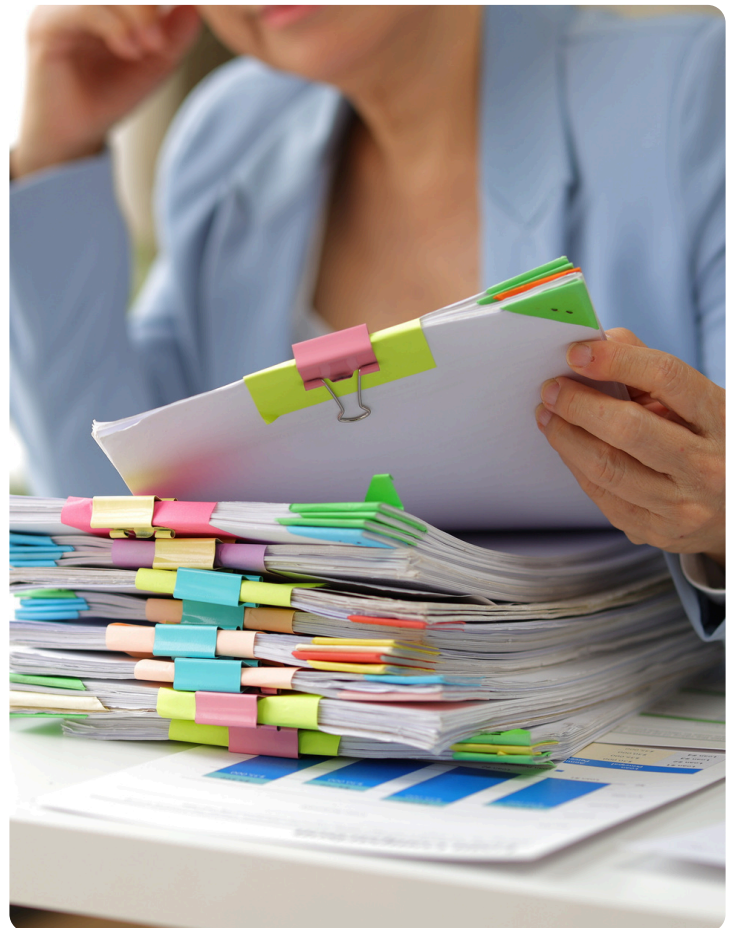
ROCKS CONSISTENTLY DON'T GET COMPLETED

COMMON SYMPTOMS

- Rock completion rates below 80 percent quarter after quarter
- Rocks reported "on track" until suddenly they're "not done"
- Vague or unmeasurable Rocks that nobody can objectively complete
- Last-minute scrambling to show "progress"
- Lots of blaming external circumstances

POSSIBLE ROOT CAUSES

- **Lousy Rock Setting:** Rocks aren't S.M.A.R.T., or aren't actually the most important work
- **Too Much on the Plate:** People are trying to do more than humanly possible
- **No Real Consequences:** Nothing happens when Rocks don't get done
- **Missing Resources:** People don't have the authority, budget, or support they need
- **Poor Planning:** The Rock owner isn't setting aside time, scheduling meetings, or thinking about dependencies that could get in the way of Rock completion



THINGS TO TRY

- Check if current Rocks actually meet S.M.A.R.T. criteria—make sure everyone agrees on what “done” looks like
- Be brutally honest about capacity and cut Rock loads if needed
- Check in on Rocks weekly and jump on problems early
- Use IDS immediately when Rocks go off track instead of hoping they'll fix themselves
- Get better at Rock setting during quarterly planning
- Create real accountability for Rock completion (not punishment, just consequences)
- Help Rock owners learn basic project management skills and tools to plan effectively

MID-MANAGERS SEEM RESISTANT OR DISENGAGED



COMMON SYMPTOMS

- Departmental Level 10 Meetings aren't happening regularly
- Managers making excuses for why "EOS won't work" in their area
- Employees confused about expectations or priorities
- The crucial link between leadership and frontline people isn't working

POSSIBLE ROOT CAUSES

- **Skepticism:** Managers think EOS will fizzle out like other past initiatives
- **Skill Gaps:** They don't feel confident teaching EOS to their teams
- **Caught in the Middle:** Stuck between old ways and new expectations
- **Left Out:** They weren't included in Rollout planning and feel like it's being done to them

THINGS TO TRY

- Sit down one-on-one and really listen to their concerns
- Give extra training and support to managers who need it
- Make it clear that EOS makes their job easier, not harder
- Let managers have a say in how EOS gets rolled out in their areas
- Create a manager's group for Rollout feedback and problem-solving

DIFFERENT DEPARTMENTS ARE IMPLEMENTING EOS INCONSISTENTLY

COMMON SYMPTOMS

- Some teams crushing Level 10 Meetings while others barely show up
- Different EOS language and approaches across departments
- Wildly different Rock completion and Scorecard discipline
- Employees confused about what's expected company-wide
- Cross-department projects getting messy due to different approaches

POSSIBLE ROOT CAUSES

- **Inconsistent Leadership:** Department heads have different levels of commitment
- **Cultural Differences:** Departments have their own established ways of doing things
- **Uneven Support:** Some departments getting more help and training
- **Unclear Standards:** Nobody's defined what "good enough" looks like across the company



THINGS TO TRY

- Set minimum standards for EOS across all departments (and stick to them)
- Figure out which departments are struggling and why
- Redistribute support to the teams that need it most
- Get departments sharing what's working with each other
- Set up mentoring between strong and struggling departments
- Make training and onboarding consistent everywhere

PEOPLE DON'T UNDERSTAND OR REMEMBER THE VISION



COMMON SYMPTOMS

- Team members can't explain Core Values, Core Focus, or other V/TO® pieces
- They nod during presentations but can't connect vision to their daily work
- People can't give examples of living the values
- Decisions don't seem to reflect vision alignment

POSSIBLE ROOT CAUSES

- **Information Overload:** Trying to share too much vision content too fast
- **Not Enough Repetition:** Vision shared once or twice instead of constantly
- **Too Abstract:** Talking concepts instead of practical examples
- **No Connection:** People can't see how vision relates to what they actually do

THINGS TO TRY

- Slow down and focus on one V/TO piece at a time
- Give real examples of how vision shows up in everyday work
- Have regular "vision check" conversations to see what's sticking
- Connect vision to current projects and decisions people are making
- Help departments figure out what company vision means for their specific work
- Train managers to weave vision into normal conversations

SCORECARDS AREN'T DRIVING THE RIGHT CONVERSATIONS OR ACTIONS

COMMON SYMPTOMS

- Teams track numbers religiously, but Scorecard reviews feel like going through the motions
- Numbers get reported without discussion or analysis
- Off-track numbers don't lead to problem-solving
- People can't explain what drives their numbers

POSSIBLE ROOT CAUSES

- **Wrong Numbers:** Tracking "nice to know" stuff instead of "need to know" indicators
- **Too Many Numbers:** If everything is important, nothing is important
- **No Clear Targets:** Numbers without goals don't create accountability
- **Bad Data:** Inaccurate or missing information makes discussions pointless
- **No Action Focus:** Teams report numbers but don't talk about what to do



THINGS TO TRY

- Ask about each number: "Does this actually drive decisions or actions?"
- Set clear goals for every number so people know what "on track" means
- Fix data collection so numbers are accurate and timely
- Train people to ask "Why?" when numbers are off and "What are we going to do?"
- Get rid of numbers that never spark conversation
- Add leading indicators that help predict problems before they hit

INITIAL ENTHUSIASM HAS FADED AND OLD HABITS ARE RETURNING



COMMON SYMPTOMS

- The launch excitement has worn off, and people are sliding back to old ways
- Level 10 Meetings getting skipped, Rock discipline getting sloppy
- Vision talk disappearing from daily conversations
- Meeting attendance and engagement declining
- People stop using EOS language when it's not required

POSSIBLE ROOT CAUSES

- **Change Fatigue:** People naturally resist sustained behavior change—it's biology
- **Not Seeing Results:** Teams haven't experienced enough wins to keep them motivated
- **Leadership Slipping:** Leaders skip EOS disciplines, sending the wrong message
- **Lack of Reinforcement:** Old habits are easier and more comfortable

THINGS TO TRY

- Leadership team needs to publicly recommit and model the behavior
- Find and celebrate specific wins that came from EOS—make success visible
- Address the slide directly with individuals and teams
- Remind people why you're doing this and what's at stake
- Make EOS adherence visible and expected, not just hoped for
- Create success stories that highlight real benefits people are experiencing

NEW HIRES AREN'T INTEGRATING WELL INTO THE EOS CULTURE

COMMON SYMPTOMS

- New people struggling to understand expectations or participate in meetings
- They seem confused by EOS terminology or resistant to the structure
- New hires can't explain basic EOS concepts after 4–6 weeks
- They're passive in Level 10 Meetings or not participating well

POSSIBLE ROOT CAUSES

- **Weak Onboarding:** EOS isn't built into new hire orientation
- **Culture Shock:** New employees come from less structured places
- **No Support System:** Nobody's helping them learn EOS Tools and expectations
- **Hiring Mismatch:** Recruiting process doesn't check for EOS compatibility



THINGS TO TRY

- Build comprehensive EOS orientation into the first week for every new hire
- Assign EOS mentors to guide new people through their first quarter
- Give them *What the Heck is EOS?* and other learning resources
- Set up 30/60/90 day check-ins specifically about vision and EOS integration
- Pair new hires with people who love EOS for peer learning

NEW LEADERS ARE UNDERMINING EOS DISCIPLINE



COMMON SYMPTOMS

- New managers suggesting "better" meeting formats they used at previous companies
- Implementation of complex management systems that bypass Rock discipline
- Creation of reporting structures that conflict with your Accountability Chart®
- Comments like "This is too basic" or "We don't need all this structure"
- Teams becoming confused about which systems to follow
- EOS Tools and disciplines are "drifting" or being abandoned
- Employees questioning whether the organization is still committed to EOS

POSSIBLE ROOT CAUSES

- **Pressure to Prove Value:** New leaders feel they need to show immediate impact by introducing familiar methods
- **EOS Learning Curve:** Learning new systems feels uncomfortable for accomplished professionals who are used to being experts
- **Competing Methodologies:** They bring impressive toolboxes full of systems that conflict with EOS
- **Inadequate Onboarding:** EOS expectations weren't made clear during hiring or orientation
- **Cultural Misunderstanding:** They don't realize that undermining EOS threatens the foundation of organizational success

THINGS TO TRY

- Make it crystal clear during interviews that your organization runs on EOS, and all leaders must embrace these tools
- Pair new leaders with successful EOS champions who can guide them
- When new leaders suggest alternatives or try to implement competing systems, have direct conversations about expectations
- Explain that while their experience is valuable, organizational success comes from everyone following the same system
- Give them *What the Heck is EOS?* and other materials to deepen understanding

REMEMBER

You didn't hire them to change your operating system; you hired them to excel within it. The strength of your EOS implementation depends on everyone, especially leaders, consistently following the same system. Don't let new talent dilute the discipline that created your success in the first place.

GENERAL TROUBLESHOOTING IDEAS

WHEN YOU HIT ANY ROLLOUT CHALLENGE, KEEP THESE THINGS IN MIND:

- **Figure Out the Root Issue.** Don't jump to solutions. Ask "Why is this really happening?" before deciding what to do about it.
- **People Issues Usually Come First.** Most EOS problems are people problems wearing disguises. If someone consistently struggles, figure out if it's training, capacity, or a Right Person Right Seat issue.
- **Look at Leadership First.** If EOS isn't working at lower levels of the organization, check what the leadership team is modeling. People copy what they see, not what they hear.
- **Progress Over Perfection.** Small, steady improvements are better than dramatic changes that don't stick. Celebrate progress while keeping standards.
- **Be Patient but Persistent.** Real change takes time, but it also needs consistent reinforcement. Don't give up too fast, but don't accept chronic non-performance either.
- **Use EOS to Fix EOS Problems.** When facing EOS challenges, use EOS to solve them. Drop issues down, use IDS, and create To-dos with clear ownership.
- **Remember Why You Started.** When Rollout gets tough, reconnect with your vision and why you started this journey. The benefits are worth the effort.

DON'T BE AFRAID TO ASK FOR HELP

SOMETIMES YOU NEED AN OUTSIDE PERSPECTIVE. CONSIDER GETTING SUPPORT FROM YOUR PROFESSIONAL EOS IMPLEMENTER®, OR FROM THE WIDER COMMUNITY OF COMPANIES RUNNING ON EOS WHEN:

- Multiple issues keep happening despite your best efforts
- Leadership team alignment breaks down around EOS
- Results stay disappointing, even though you're using the tools
- Resistance becomes widespread and entrenched
- You want objective assessment and specific recommendations

Getting help isn't giving up; it's being smart about success.

Every organization successfully running on EOS has faced these challenges and worked through them. The key is staying committed to getting EOS followed by all, while learning and adapting as you go.

Your Rollout isn't failing because you hit problems; it's succeeding because you're committed to solving them. Keep going, keep learning, and keep trusting the process.

The vision you've created is worth the effort it takes to get there.

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**BRING EOS[®] TO YOUR
WHOLE TEAM**

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GET YOUR BOOK TODAY!



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